



Parks Commission Recreation - Report 1/14/2026

ALL Community Centers

Basketball teams were practicing until the school break. Each center held their Christmas events during the week of December 15 - 19, 2025.

Southwest Community Center

Letters to Santa (Dec. 1–20): Youth participated in a holiday-themed literacy activity promoting creativity and family engagement.

Dunbar Community Center

Partnered with DHNA to do a food giveaway on Tuesday, December 23rd from 11am-1pm. Potluck delivered 1500 lbs. of food and plastic bags to be given out to citizens.

Special Events:

Special Events held:

- 1) Southwest: Open House & Panthers Cookout (Dec. 4): Open House (Dec. 8); Lotería Night (Dec. 12); Brunch with Santa (Dec. 13). These events strengthened community engagement, increased center visibility, and promoted ongoing programming.
- 2) West Central: December Coat Drive to give to Dunbar Community Center for the Warming Shelter. The Coat drive ended December 30, 2025. They are to help the ones that come to Center for the shelter and need the assistance.
- 3) West Central held their 2nd annual Jamboree Youth Basketball games on December 27; there were 10 games played.

Youth Athletics

Basketball registration closure was on Dec. 19th.

- **Basketball** – *Participation and attendance in community centers*
Registration 2025 – 402 Current 2026 – 411 Increase- ~2%

Therapeutic Recreation

The 12th Annual TR Christmas Program took place on December 18th. This event is hosted by WLR Fellowship Bible Church- Embrace Special Needs Ministry. There were 17 participants in this year's cast, originally 19 in the cast but two were out with illness. There were approximately 100 attendees in the audience. Great success! The TR Volunteer Crew, which is made up of members of the Branch Out Program, once again hosted a Blanket Drive in conjunction with Chloe's Cozy Drive. 40 blankets were donated and will be delivered to the City's Homeless Services Division for distribution to those in need.

MacArthur Museum

Special Events – Average 2 special events each month.

Baseline 2024 – 24 special events Goal 2025 – 24 special events

Current 2025 (January – December) – 48 special events (200% of goal)



Parks Commission – Recreation Report

Dunbar Community Center

After School Programs

The after-school program at Dunbar Community Center wrapped up this month. Youth enjoyed our annual holiday meal on December 19th and received gifts from the center. Gifts included stuffed animals, games of their choice and Christmas pencils. We will start registration for the second semester on the 2nd of January online.

Youth Basketball Program

This month we continued practicing basketball our season starts in January 2026. No practices were held during the LRSD Christmas break.

Free Play

During the last two weeks of the month the center was open to all youth to attend for free play in the gym. Staff were on hand to keep the youth safe and interacted with them.

Special Event

We partnered with DHNA to do a food giveaway on Tuesday, December 23rd from 11am-1pm. Potluck delivered 1500 lbs. of food and plastic bags to be given out to citizens.

Southwest Community Center

Youth Programs:

Letters to Santa (Dec. 1–20): Youth participated in a holiday-themed literacy activity promoting creativity and family engagement.

Winter Break Camp: Dec 22–Jan 2, 7:30 a.m.–5 p.m. Closed December 25, 2025 & January 1, 2026. The camp has 12 youth registered. Field trips, daily meals, and indoor/outdoor recreation activities are finalized including a sculpture scavenger hunt in the River Market District, a visit to the AGFC Nature Center, and a festive “Noon” Year’s Eve celebration with our friends at Dee Brown Library. .

Afterschool & Engagement: Youth participation remained steady through supervised open play and enrichment activities prior to winter break.

Dance Program: Continued through early December, average Attendance: 5–10 participants on Tuesdays & Thursdays, 5:30–6:30 p.m. Monthly Fee: \$10 per participant

Youth Athletics:

Basketball Program (Pre-Season Practices Only): Focused on drills, fundamentals, conditioning, and team development across 6U, 8U, 10U, and 12U divisions. League play begins January 2026.

Cheer Program (Practice Phase): Participants continued routine development and skill preparation for the upcoming basketball season.

Adult Fitness Programs

Southwest Steppers (Dance Workout): Average Attendance: 8 participants on Tuesdays & Thursdays, 6:00–7:00 p.m. Program remains staff-led while a volunteer instructor is being sought.

Low-Impact Senior Workout: A video-based program serving approximately 15 older adults, providing safe and consistent physical activity.

Pickleball: Interest and feasibility continue to be evaluated; no program was launched in December.

Special Events & Community Outreach

Open House & Panthers Cookout (Dec. 4): Open House (Dec. 8); Lotería Night (Dec. 12); Brunch with Santa (Dec. 13). These events strengthened community engagement, increased center visibility, and promoted ongoing programming.

Looking Ahead – January 2026

Southwest Panthers Basketball Season Tip-Off

Vision Board Workshops: Goal setting and self-development sessions for youth and community members

Lotería Nights: (Jan. 5) Hosted for the Active & Aging population and **(Jan. 16):** Community-wide event

Stephens Community Center

Star Student Afterschool Program

Spring Semester registration has begun. The After-school Program for Fall. (68%). Reindeer Roundup: was held on 12/18/25 at 3:00 pm. For afterschool participants.

Youth Sports Program

Programs for Youth: Cheerleading (100+%), Youth Basketball 23 registered.

Adult Activities:

The Men's 40 & Over League. We will push for spring.

Facility Vacancies:

3-Activity Assistants, 1-Part-Time Custodian and 1-Full Time Custodian. We still have help from the CUP while they are under Renovation.

West Central Community Center

Youth Sports Program:

We held our 2nd annual Jamboree Basketball games on December 27; there were 10 games played.. Basketball practices take place Monday – Thursday 6 – 8:30pm.

Other Program:

We are looking into starting a mentoring program with Parkview students. We have an overview prepared for what we have to offer with the mentorship. In January we are planning to introduce the mentorship program for Parkview students. This will include registration, marketing, and finding more volunteers to help with this program for it to succeed.

Karate/Dance:

The Karate program is back and has 15 participants. Dance has 10 participants. Both were closed for Holiday Season.

West Central CC:

Eastern Seals basketball team comes weekly to practice and have physical education.

Sunshine Homeschool comes on Tuesdays at 1pm to do physical education.

Both Men's and Women's teams of Parkview High School practice at West Central from 2pm-6pm Monday-Thursday.

Employment:

We have a concessionaire, activity assistant (2) and evening front desk receptionist to hire. Currently looking at applications.

ELR Community Center

Housing and Neighborhood Programs held their end of the year wrap-up on December 18, and all went well. I am continuing to complete all the training courses required, including bi-weekly safety briefings on Cybersecurity Awareness ***The Inside Man Series*** on December 10, more will be scheduled through the COLR IT Department. The neighborhood Meeting scheduled for December 8 was cancelled by their president and plans are to resume their meetings January 2026. The LRPR department held their work order meeting this month, there were about 16 in total for the meeting. Estem High School continued to hold drills, shoot around and free-throw shooting until their winter break. I am still attending various meetings/activities/events as scheduled. Continuing to assist supervisors, help with Aging & Active program as needed and attend various training courses as scheduled. Individuals are still utilizing the tennis court area for skateboarding (not looking the best). Maintenance continues to mulch leaves, weed eat, and pick up around the entire grounds. The community groups are still using the outdoor basketball/tennis courts/area and other areas to do exercises, meet, and fitness as the weather permits. They are there 3 to 5 days per week, with about 6 - 8 people. There is still use of the field/park...daily/weekends, family gatherings, tennis court (hopefully to be refurbished as multi-use courts) for walking and playing matches, and other activities.

Senior Programs: Active and Aging

Baptist Health held their monthly fruit & vegetable outreach at Southwest, East Little Rock, and Dunbar. Dunbar took their second field trip to Homers Kitchen on December 18 (they enjoyed it SO much the first time!). East LR, Southwest and West Central had their Holiday Celebration at their site and did gift exchange on December 19. West Central also played against other sites in chair volleyball and continued their bean bag baseball. Continued Shout outs to ALL the Senior Staff for their hard work, dedication, and for the care.

****All sites were on Holiday break December 22, 2025, and will resume the first week of January 2026.**

Dunbar Seniors: Homers Kitchen, Birthday celebrations, Bingo/connect bingo, Walking, Exercising, Dominoes, Arts & Crafts, Weekly Field Trips, Bible Study, Baptist Health Outreach and Monthly Screenings, painting.

East Little Rock Seniors: Baptist Health, Speakers, Ceramics, Birthday Celebrations, Arts & Crafts, Bean Bag Baseball, Line Dancing, Mind Bending, Silver Foxes Dance Class, Senior Chair Fitness, Puzzles, Adult Coloring, Jewelry & T-Shirt Making.

Southwest Seniors: Baptist Health food drive, Birthday Celebrations, Ring Toss, Bingo, Skip-Bo, Card/Table Games, Bible Study, Chair Exercise, bowling, bean bag, Crafts, and Walking Club.

West Central Seniors: Baptist Health, Quilting, Dance, Table games, Bible Study, Bingo, Pickleball Free play, Chair Volleyball games home/away, Bean Bag Baseball (Badgers/Blazers (League games home/away), and Pickle ball games/Practice (both teams).

Therapeutic Recreation

The 12th Annual TR Christmas Program took place on December 18th. This event is hosted by WLR Fellowship Bible Church- Embrace Special Needs Ministry. There were 17 participants in this year's cast, originally 19 in the cast but two were out with illness. There were approximately 100 attendees in the audience. Great success! The TR Volunteer Crew, which is made up of members of the Branch Out

Program, once again hosted a Blanket Drive in conjunction with Chloe's Cozy Drive. 40 blankets were donated and will be delivered to the City's Homeless Services Division for distribution to those in need. 2025 Fall Session concluded on December 19th. The Spring Session will begin on January 12 with registration beginning on January 5th.

Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatics

MEMBERSHIPS

Added Email/Text Alerts to communicate with members when classes are cancelled, etc. Have over 300 people enrolled in text alerts. **Memberships:** 2024 (to date): 15,109 **2025 (to date, December): 24,865.

Revenue: 2024 (to date): \$376,939.14 **2025 (to date): \$596,594.67

FITNESS PROGRAMS

The facility continues to offer **19 group fitness classes**, all of which maintain high participation rates and positive feedback from members.

Commit to Fit 6 - Week Challenge Registration started on December 12, 2025

Activities: Start Open Gym Volleyball, TBD.

AQUATICS PROGRAMS

The aquatics program currently offers **6 classes**, which continue to show steady attendance and positive participant feedback. Satisfaction and engagement remain consistently high.

One new aquatic fitness: Add Aqua Fit on Wednesdays at 6:00pm.

SPECIAL ACTIVITIES

Baptist Health Community Outreach

Clothing Drive for Dorcas House (December 12, 2025 – January 1, 2026)

Monthly blood pressure screenings were provided in November, with **27 participants** benefiting from this free service.

The Centre at University Park (Currently Under Renovation)

Youth Athletics

Basketball

The 2026 basketball registration closed on December 19th. All centers are closed on Active Net. There are 412 participants registered. All ages have been divided into recreation and competitive divisions. All centers are holding practices throughout the winter break. Every recreation team has received new jerseys for the league. The season will commence on January 5th. Soccer registration has opened and flyers are being revised and being resent.

Basketball Registrations: Dunbar: 153, Southwest: 50, Stephens: 23, West Central: 186, Total: 412

Cheerleading

The cheer season is ongoing. They will cheer at basketball games and other community functions as scheduled. Registration will remain open. There are currently 32 enrolled.

Adult Athletics

Interstate Park Program

ALL park ballfield reservations are CLOSED until March 2026

Adult Basketball Program The 30 and 40 and over basketball league is on hold until 2026 and as of now will be played at East Little Rock Community Center. We have 6 confirmed teams in each division

Parks Summer Day Camp

Planning has already begun for the summer of 2026 Parks Summer Day Camp supplies will be ordered in the next couple of weeks for the program.

Allsop Park

We have closed reservations until 2026, but fields can still be used.

Kanis Park

Arkansas Baptist college continues to utilize Kanis baseball field. Also, Philander Smith University uses it as well.

Rebsamen and First Tee Golf

Cold weather slowed down the play in December. First Tee: The grass sod farm is coming along very well and should be ready by spring to help replace some of the damaged tee boxes. Driving range at First Tee is good shape. Range balls are being picked up regularly. Repainting of exterior has been quoted but has not been scheduled.

First Tee: New phone install at facility. Also, getting new numbers out to the public. We are still collaborating with the Director and Deputy Directors on the bond funding allocated for golf. Repainting of interior will be put to bid during the fall and plan for painting to be underway during late fall or early winter at Rebsamen.

In 2026, both courses will significantly reduce purchasing of high-ticket items such as Golf Bags and Golf Clubs, as they do not sell well at either facility, and utilize those funds to purchase higher selling items such as Golf Balls and Gloves.

Rebsamen Tennis

We were fairly slow over the holiday. Had a small adult USTA tournament a couple of weekends this month with about 25 players – not bad for as cold as it was.

ATA has used our courts on two Sundays for state tournaments (they also used Burns Park since they have more courts there). Golf cart is broken and has been picked up and still in North Little Rock to be fixed (waiting to hear). USTA Team Tennis (Tri-level and mixed seasons) finishing up. We had 15 tri-level teams and 60 mixed doubles teams. USTA Team Triple Threat season started in early November and goes through the beginning of the year. USTA Singles leagues began early November as well and goes through mid-January. Putting together a grant proposal through the USTA to help with court resurfacing. Will continue to bid for tournament in the coming months.

Museum of Arkansas Military History

Museum monthly attendance for December was 1,635. This number includes: (1) on-site visitation, (2) special events, (3) virtual programming through the museum's mini-documentaries and interviews, and (4) off-site programming and outreach.

On-site visitation includes 498 walk-in guests and 565 visitors to special events, meetings, tours, etc. In addition to Arkansas, visitors have come from 21 states, including Alabama, Arizona, California, Colorado, Florida, Georgia, Illinois, Kansas, Louisiana, Massachusetts, Minnesota, Missouri, New Jersey, North Carolina, Ohio, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, Tennessee, Texas, Utah, and Virginia, as well as Australia, Mexico, and Germany. Off-site programming reached a total of 275 individuals during December, while the museum's virtual programming received 297 new views. Overall attendance thus far in 2025 totals

35,403, which is 102% of the museum's goal. During 2025, a total of 17,834 guests participated in on-site visitation and special events (50%), 5,974 views of virtual programming (17%) and 11,595 reached through off-site outreach and programming (33%).

The museum received \$11,038.50 in donations in December, including \$10,210 in sponsorships for the *Thomas Hart Benton* exhibit. Total fundraising for 2025 was \$63,575: this amount more than doubles the annual goal of raising \$30,000. Since 2016 the museum has raised over \$612,500 in outside funding through grants, sponsorships and donations. Gift shop sales for the year were \$12,327.31, exceeding the 2025 goal by 8% and setting a record for highest gift shop sales in a single year since the museum opened in 2001.

Museum programmers Shane Lind and David Collins continue weekly Afterschool Programming at Stephens and Dunbar Community Centers, as well as monthly programming to students in the 21st Century program at JA Fair Preparatory Academy. During December, a total of 169 students were reached through programming at the Community Centers in addition to 31 students at J.A. Fair. So far this Fall, a total of 1077 students have been reached at the sites: (1) Dunbar Community Center – 534, (2) Stephens Community Center – 391, and (3) J.A. Fair Preparatory Academy – 152.

Thomas Hart Benton, a traveling exhibit from the Naval History and Heritage Command in Washington DC, continues to receive favorable response from the public. It features 25 original paintings and drawings depicting naval scenes on board the submarine USS *Dorado* and LSTs along the Ohio and Mississippi Rivers. These artworks were commissioned by Abbott Laboratories and turned over to the Navy after the war. The exhibit will remain on display through July 31.

The museum hosted three holiday concerts during December. Forty-four people attended the concert of the 106th Army Band's "Low Brass" ensemble group on December 6. Thirty persons attended the "Jazz, Jingles and Joy," concert featuring the Jacksonville High School Choir on December 13. Forty-three people attended the annual holiday concert featuring students from the Margaret Wyatt Piano and Vocal Studio on December 21.

The museum's "Movies at MacArthur" film series resumes in January, which marks the program's twelfth year. Since starting in 2015, a total of 3,918 people has attended one or more screenings of movies depicting various topics in our state and nation's military history. The 2026 movie schedule has been finalized and is attached, as well as a flyer for the January 20 film, *Miles, Morale and Memory: Bob Hope and World War II*.

The museum hosted the following school groups/tours in December:

182 4th grade students, parents and teachers from Sheridan on December 9

24 students and parents from Cornerstone Christian Academy in Tillar on December 9

96 7th grade students, parents and teachers from Goza Middle School in Arkadelphia on December 12

Programs and Special Events Coming Up January - March:

January 20 – Movies at MacArthur, *Miles, Morale and Memories: Bob Hope and World War II*, 6:30 – 8:30 pm

January 25 – Lecture and Book Signing with Sherman Fleek, author of *MacArthur and West Point: How the General and the Academy Shaped Each Other*, 2 pm

January 27 – Lecture and Book Signing with David Sesser, author of *The Little Rock Arsenal Crisis: On the Precipice of the American Civil War*, 7 – 8 pm

February 17 – Movies at MacArthur, *Black Patriots: Buffalo Soldiers*, 6:30 – 8 pm

February 22 – Vintage Military Gear Show, 1:00 – 5:00 pm

March 7 – Lecture, *French Arkansas*, with Dr. Nate Marvin, Francophonie Festival, 2 pm

March 12 - Lecture, *Revolutionary Warfare: How the Algerian War Made Modern Counterinsurgency*, with Dr. Terrence G. Peterson, 6 – 7:30 pm

March 17 – Movies at MacArthur, *The Donut Dollies: 627 Women Who Also Served in Vietnam*, 6:30 – 8 pm

March 24 – "An Evening with Curt Fields as General Ulysses S. Grant," 7 – 9 pm

March 25 – “An Evening with Curt Fields as President Ulysses S. Grant,” 7 – 9 pm

Outdoor Recreation

Outdoor Recreation Facebook page has 585 followers and has shown consistent growth on a weekly basis. The War Memorial Disc Golf project is moving forward. A preliminary course design has been established and will be presented to the public for feedback at a disc golf pop-up event in early 2026. Meetings have been set for early January to discuss pop-up dates, public interest meetings and course construction dates. The 2026 dates for the 3rd annual Squatch Till You Drop trail running event have been set and been released to the public as a “save the date” post on Facebook. Outdoor Recreation is working with the Grants department to explore possible funding sources. I completed all Cyber Security trainings to date. Lunchtime mtn bike rides on the new trails at Allsopp started in October. Rides are scheduled for 12pm-1pm on Tuesdays and 11am-12pm on Thursdays. Rides have been held most weeks (weather cancelations and Holidays are the exception). I have coordinated with city Homeless Advocates to provide assistance to members of our unsheltered community in and around War Memorial Park. This is an ongoing situation.